

Trump Accounts: A Family Decision Workbook

Financially Sovereign Academy · A Sovereign Academy property · Workbook v1.0 · 24 August 2026

What this is. Eight worksheets. No secret information — everything the worksheets rest on is published free at financiallysovereign.academy/kits/trump-account-family-decision-guide, with every source linked. What you are holding is the structure that turns that information into a decision you actually made, in writing, with your reasoning next to it, so that in two years you can look back and know what you were thinking.

What this is not. Not financial, investment, legal, or tax advice, and not a recommendation to open, fund, or skip anything. Not affiliated with the U.S. government, the Treasury, or the IRS. No one here can see your situation. Where a worksheet tells you to go ask a professional, that is the worksheet working correctly.

How to use it. Print it. Sit down with the other adult who has a say, if there is one. Work through Worksheet 1 first — it is the only one that decides anything. Worksheets 2 through 8 support that decision or come after it. Expect forty-five minutes for the first pass. Use pencil.

A note on what is settled and what is not. As of this printing, some rules are law, some are proposed, and some are simply unanswered. Every worksheet marks which is which. Anything marked **PROPOSED** can still change. Worksheet 8 lists the source behind every factual claim in this workbook so you can check any of it yourself, and re-check it later.

Where this fits. Worksheet 1 decides. Worksheet 2 compares. Worksheet 3 tracks the annual limit. Worksheet 4 is for your employer. Worksheet 5 is for your children. Worksheet 6 is for when something goes wrong. Worksheet 7 is for seventeen years from now. Worksheet 8 is the receipts.

Worksheet 1 — Is this right for us?

Decide this one before anything else. The \$1,000 is not what you are deciding about.

Claiming the \$1,000 pilot contribution and *adding your own money* are two different decisions. This worksheet is about the second one. Most families should treat the first as straightforward and the second as genuinely open.

Step 1. Separate the two decisions

- Have we claimed, or will we claim, the \$1,000 pilot contribution? **Yes / No / Not eligible**
- Today's question is only this: **do we put our own money in?** (circle) **Yes · No · Not yet**

Step 2. The lock-up, in our own words

The money cannot come out before **1 January of the year the child turns 18**, with narrow exceptions. Write what that means for your family specifically.

- The child is ____ years old now. That is roughly ____ **years** of no access.
- If our household hit a serious emergency in that window, would we wish this money back? **Yes / No / Unsure**
- Money we would be putting in that we might otherwise need: \$ _____

Step 3. The tax timing, in our own words

Growth is **tax-deferred, not tax-free**. Under traditional IRA treatment, withdrawals are generally taxed as ordinary income when they come out, and a 10% early-distribution charge can apply until the usual retirement-age conditions are met.

- Say it back in one sentence, without using the word “deferred”: _____
-
- Does anyone in this household believe the money is simply available at 18? **Yes / No** If yes, who needs correcting before this goes further? _____

Step 4. What we would be giving up

Money put here is money not put somewhere else. Name the somewhere else honestly.

If we did not put it here, it would go to	Amount	Would that be better for us?
Emergency savings	\$ _____	Yes / No / Unsure
Paying down debt at ____% interest	\$ _____	Yes / No / Unsure
A 529 for education	\$ _____	Yes / No / Unsure
A custodial Roth, if the child has earned income	\$ _____	Yes / No / Unsure
Nothing — it would just be spent	\$ _____	Yes / No / Unsure

If any row above is a clear “yes, that would be better,” Worksheet 2 is where you compare it properly.

Step 5. The three gates

Answer all three. A “no” on any one of them is a legitimate reason to stop, and stopping is a real answer.

1. **Liquidity gate.** Do we have money set aside for an emergency that is *not* this money? **Yes / No**

2. **Debt gate.** Are we carrying high-interest debt that costs us more than this is likely to earn? **Yes / No**
3. **Understanding gate.** Can both adults explain the lock-up and the tax treatment without reading it off a page? **Yes / No**

Step 6. The decision, in writing

Circle one and then write the reason. The reason matters more than the circle — it is the part you will need in two years.

We are contributing · We are not contributing · We are waiting until _____

If contributing: amount per month or per year: \$ _____

Why we decided this: _____

What would change our mind: _____

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Step 7. Set the re-check

Rules on this topic are still moving. Decide now when you will look again, so it is a calendar item rather than a worry.

- We re-read this sheet on: _____ (suggested: twelve months from today)
- We also re-read it if: a proposed rule becomes final · our income changes · our childcare or housing costs change · _____

Worksheet 2 — Side by side

Five accounts, compared on the four things that actually differ. Structure, not a recommendation — no column here is “the winner,” and which one fits depends on facts this page cannot see.

The comparison

	Trump Account	529 plan	Custodial Roth IRA	UTMA / UGMA	Ordinary brokerage
Who can put money in	Parents, others, and an employer up to \$2,500/yr	Anyone	Anyone, but only up to the child's own earned income	Anyone	Anyone
Annual limit	\$5,000 combined, indexed after 2027	No federal annual cap; gift-tax rules apply	The lesser of the child's earned income or the IRA limit	No cap	No cap
Does an employer contribution count against the limit	Yes — inside the \$5,000	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
When money can come out	Not before 1 Jan of the year the child turns 18, narrow exceptions	Anytime, but non-qualified withdrawals are penalized	Contributions anytime; earnings restricted	Anytime, for the child's benefit	Anytime
Tax timing	Deferred; taxed as ordinary income on withdrawal	Growth tax-free if used for qualified education	Qualified withdrawals can be tax-free	Taxed as it goes; child's rates, kiddie-tax rules	Taxed as it goes
Early-withdrawal charge	10% may apply, traditional-IRA rules	10% on the earnings portion, non-qualified	10% on earnings, exceptions apply	None	None
Who controls it at 18-21	The beneficiary, under IRA rules	The account owner keeps control	The child, at majority	The child, automatically at the state's age	Whoever owns the account

	Trump Account	529 plan	Custodial Roth IRA	UTMA / UGMA	Ordinary brokerage
Investment choice	LAW: U.S. stock index funds tracking a qualified index, annual fees and expenses ≤0.10% of the balance, no sector index. PROPOSED: ESG exclusion, 90% U.S.-company safe harbor	Menu set by the plan	Wide open	Wide open	Wide open
Counts against college financial aid as	Not yet clarified	Parent asset, if parent-owned	Retirement asset, generally excluded	Student asset — weighted heaviest	Parent asset, if parent-owned

*The fee cap, the qualified-index requirement and the sector-index exclusion are in the statute (26 U.S.C. §530A) and cannot change without Congress. What was **proposed** on 21 August 2026, comments open until 20 October 2026, is narrower: the ESG exclusion, the 90% U.S.-company safe harbor, the Investment Company Act registration requirement, and the definition of leverage. See Worksheet 8.*

What the table cannot tell you

Fill this in. It is the part that decides.

- The thing we actually want this money to do: _____
- The year we would want it available: _____
- Does any account above match that year better than the Trump Account? **Yes / No** — which: _____
- Whose money is it meant to be at 18 — the child's, unconditionally? **Yes / No / We have not discussed it**

Two traps in this table

“More accounts is more diversified.” It is not. Five accounts with \$200 in each is one small pile of money and five sets of paperwork, statements, and logins that someone has to maintain for seventeen years. Name a reason for each account you open.

“Tax-free” and “tax-deferred” read the same and are not. Circle which one applies to each: Trump Account (**free / deferred**) · 529 for qualified education (**free / deferred**) · Custodial Roth, qualified (**free / deferred**).

Our ranking

Rank the five from 1 (best fit for our goal) to 5. Write one reason for the top one only.

____ Trump Account ____ 529 ____ Custodial Roth ____ UTMA ____ Brokerage

Reason for our number 1: _____

Worksheet 3 — The \$5,000 sheet

One page, one calendar year. Everything that counts toward the limit, in one place, so nobody finds out in December.

The regular contribution limit is **\$5,000 per calendar year**, indexed for inflation after 2027. The mistake families make is not knowing what counts.

What counts, and what does not

Counts toward the \$5,000:

- What you contribute
- What relatives and friends contribute
- **What an employer contributes — up to \$2,500 per employee per year, and it sits *inside* the \$5,000, not on top of it**

Does not count toward the \$5,000:

- The \$1,000 government pilot contribution
- Other government contributions
- Qualified charitable contributions
- Rollovers into the account

Calendar year 20____

Date	Who contributed	Relationship	Amount	Running total
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
_____	_____	_____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Employer, year to date	_____	employer	\$ _____	
		TOTAL	\$ _____	

Room left this year: \$5,000 – \$ _____ = \$ _____

One child, one row set. Copy this page for each child — the limit is per beneficiary.

Who is the traffic controller

If more than one person contributes, one of you has to be the one who knows the total. Contributions from several people who each assume they are under the limit are how an excess contribution happens.

- The person tracking this: _____
- How relatives tell that person before contributing: _____
- The month we check the total on purpose: _____ (suggested: October)

Two things nobody announced

Both of these are unresolved as of this printing, and both affect this page.

- **Proration for 2026.** The program began 4 July 2026. No proration of the annual limit has been announced. Note what you assumed: _____
- **Carryforward.** The law provides no carryforward of unused limit. Unused room does not roll to next year.

When a relative wants to contribute

Gift tax, usually not an issue. Under a June 2026 IRS revenue procedure, cash contributions to a Trump Account for a beneficiary under 18 count as completed gifts of present interests eligible for the annual gift tax exclusion — which removes a Form 709 filing requirement the account's own restrictions would otherwise have raised. The relief is conditional. It applies where the donor's only taxable gifts are cash contributions to Trump Accounts, the contribution is made before the beneficiary turns 18, total gifts to that beneficiary stay within the annual exclusion (\$19,000 for 2026), no gift or GST tax is owed, and the donor is not otherwise required to file a gift tax return that year. Outside those limits, ordinary gift tax rules apply.

- Any single donor giving this child more than the annual exclusion this year? **Yes / No** — if yes, that donor should talk to a tax professional before giving.

If the relative lives outside the United States, stop and get advice first. The safe harbor above is written for donors who are natural persons; for donors who are not U.S. persons, the gift tax treatment of cash transfers is not fully settled and is highly fact-specific. This is not a question to settle with a rule of thumb.

- Is any prospective contributor a non-U.S. person or living abroad? **Yes / No**
- If yes, who we will ask for cross-border advice before they contribute: _____

Worksheet 4 — Questions for your employer

Hand this page to HR or payroll as it is. You do not need to explain why you are asking.

An employer may contribute up to **\$2,500 per employee per year**, and that amount counts **inside** the \$5,000 annual limit for the child — not on top of it. Most employers are working this out at the same time you are. Asking early, in writing, is normal.

To: _____ (HR / Benefits / Payroll) **From:** _____ **Date:** _____

I am asking about Trump Accounts for a dependent child. I would appreciate written answers where you have them, and “we do not know yet” where you do not.

1. Does the company currently contribute to employee Trump Accounts? **Yes / No / Under consideration** Notes: _____

2. If yes, how much per employee per year, and is it per employee or per child?

3. Is a contribution automatic, or do I have to elect it? If I have to elect it, what is the deadline and where is the form?

4. Is there an enrollment window, and does it line up with open enrollment?

5. How and when will I be told the amount actually contributed, and in what document? *(I need this figure to stay under the \$5,000 combined annual limit.)*

6. If the company contributes mid-year, how do I find out in time to reduce my own contributions?

7. Is the contribution treated as taxable income to me, and how will it appear on my W-2?

8. What happens to the contribution if I leave the company during the year?

9. Who is the named person I should follow up with, and by when? Name: _____ Contact: _____
Follow up by: _____

After you send it

- Date sent: _____ · Method: email / portal / in person · Reply received: **Yes / No**
- If no reply after two weeks, follow up once, in writing, to the named person above.
- **Record the employer figure on Worksheet 3 the day you learn it.** That is the number most likely to push a family over the limit without anyone noticing.

Worksheet 5 — Talking to your children

Three short conversations, ordered by the child's age. None of them is a lecture, and none of them should last more than a few minutes.

The account is in the child's name. At some point it becomes the child's money and the child's decision. What you say now shapes whether that goes well.

If the child is under 8 — the “it exists” conversation

Goal: they know it exists and that it is not for now. Nothing else.

- Say: “There is an account with your name on it. It is for when you are grown up. We are not going to use it before then.”
- **Do not** say a dollar amount to a young child. It becomes a number they repeat and compare.
- One question to ask them: “What do you think grown-ups use money for?” Then listen without correcting.

Date we had this: _____ · How it went: _____

If the child is 8 to 13 — the “waiting is the point” conversation

Goal: they understand that the money is locked, and why locked is not the same as punished.

- Say: “It has to sit there until you are eighteen. That is the rule of the account, not our rule.”
- Ask: “What is something you waited a long time for and were glad you waited?” Connect it to that.
- **Do not** attach it to behavior. It is not a reward and it should never be usable as a threat.
- Fair to share: that it grows, and that growing takes years, not weeks.

Date we had this: _____ · What they asked: _____

If the child is 14 to 17 — the “this becomes yours” conversation

Goal: they can explain the account back to you, including the tax part. This is the one that matters.

- Ask them to explain it to you. If they say “I get the money at 18,” correct it: the money becomes *theirs* under retirement-account rules, taxes apply when it comes out, and there can be an extra charge for taking it early.
- Ask: “What would you want to do with it?” Do not judge the answer. Write it down. Their answer:
- Say the true thing: “This will be your decision, not ours. We would rather you know how it works before than find out after.”
- Tell them where the records are. Worksheet 7 is that record.

Date we had this: _____ · Can they explain the tax treatment back? **Yes / Not yet**

What not to do, at any age

- Do not present it as “free money from the government.” It sets up a bad reaction later when they learn about the taxes.
- Do not promise what it will be worth. Nobody knows.
- Do not use it as leverage in an argument. Once you have done that once, it is a bargaining chip forever.

One line to leave them

Write the sentence you would want your child to remember about this account. Put it on Worksheet 7 too.

Worksheet 6 — When something goes wrong

Delays and rejections are widespread and usually fixable. Work down this list before concluding you do not qualify.

First: is it actually a problem, or is it just slow?

Delays were widely reported through 2026 — families told about ten days, then up to roughly four weeks. A wait is not evidence that anything is wrong with your claim.

- Date we submitted Form 4547: _____
- Weeks elapsed: _____ · Is that beyond four weeks? **Yes / No**

The checklist

Work top to bottom. Tick what you have confirmed.

- ☐ **The child's Social Security number is correct on the form.** Digit by digit, against the card.
- ☐ **The child is a U.S. citizen with a valid SSN, born 2025-2028.** These are the requirements that attach to the child.
- ☐ **The form was not attached to an amended return.** Form 4547 cannot be attached to a Form 1040-X. If you already filed, it goes in separately.
- ☐ **Identity verification is complete.** There is an ID.me verification step. An incomplete verification looks exactly like a delay.
- ☐ **Names match the SSA record exactly** — including hyphens, two last names, and suffixes.
- ☐ **We used only official addresses**, typed by hand: irs.gov/trumpaccounts and trumpaccounts.gov.

If you do not file a tax return

Not filing does not exclude you. Form 4547 can be submitted on its own, with the identity-verification step. Do not let a preparer tell you otherwise without showing you where it says so.

- Do we file a return? **Yes / No** · If no, submitted separately on: _____

If you were rejected

Rejections have been corrected in about an hour by phone. Call before you assume the answer is no.

- Date of rejection: _____ · Reason given: _____
- Date we called: _____ · Who we spoke to: _____
- What they said to fix: _____
- Resubmitted on: _____ · Outcome: _____

If you file with an ITIN, or you are a mixed-status family

The requirements that are actually published attach to the **child**: U.S. citizen, valid SSN, born 2025-2028. Official application guidance contemplates a parent filing with an ITIN. In the published guidance reviewed for this workbook, there is no requirement about a parent's immigration status. That is stated deliberately and narrowly, rather than repeating the stronger version circulating in some coverage, because the stronger version is not an official IRS position, and regulations are still arriving.

If your situation is complicated, this is a good moment to speak with a qualified tax professional or an accredited immigration legal service, rather than relying on any website — including ours.

- Who we will ask: _____ · By when: _____

Scams

- No legitimate part of claiming the \$1,000 requires paying a fee to a third party, or handing over your bank passwords. If someone asks, that is your answer.
- Start from official addresses typed by hand, never from a link in a text or a message.
- Anything we were asked for that felt wrong: _____
- Reported to: _____ · Date: _____

Worksheet 7 — The record

Photocopy this page before you write on it. Its whole job is to still be legible and findable in seventeen years.

Somebody will need this when the child turns 18 — most likely the child. Contributions and tax basis are much easier to write down as they happen than to reconstruct later.

Account identity

- Child's full legal name: _____
- Date of birth: _____
- Account opened / claim submitted: _____
- Institution holding the account: _____
- Where the login and account number are kept (*do not write the number here*): _____
- Person responsible for this record: _____
- Backup person, in case the first cannot: _____

Contribution log

Year	Family contributions	Employer contributions	Other (gov't, charitable, rollover)	Year total
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
20__	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____
Cumulative	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____

Keep going on a second copy. Eighteen years is more rows than one page holds.

Documents to keep, and where

- [] Copy of Form 4547 as submitted — kept at: _____
- [] Confirmation of the pilot contribution — kept at: _____
- [] Annual statements — kept at: _____
- [] Employer contribution confirmations — kept at: _____
- [] Records of contributions from relatives — kept at: _____
- [] This workbook — kept at: _____

Notes to whoever reads this later

The decision we made and why (*copy the sentence from Worksheet 1, Step 6*):

What we want the child to know about it (*from Worksheet 5*):

Anything that changed after we decided — new rules, a job change, a different plan:

Annual check, five minutes

Do this once a year with the statement in front of you.

Year	Statement reviewed	Total matches Worksheet 3	Anything changed in the rules	Initials
20__	[]	[]	_____	_____
20__	[]	[]	_____	_____
20__	[]	[]	_____	_____
20__	[]	[]	_____	_____

Worksheet 8 — Where every fact came from

Check any of it. That is what this page is for. Verify before you rely on anything here, including this workbook — rules on this topic are still arriving.

Primary sources

What it supports	Source	Where
Investment restrictions: 0.10% fee cap on the balance, qualified-index requirement, primarily U.S. companies, no sector index, restriction runs until the year the child turns 18	26 U.S.C. §530A	uscode.house.gov — title 26, section 530A
Program start, 4 July 2026; \$1,000 pilot contribution	U.S. Treasury press release, 2026-07-04	home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0554
Program overview; official starting point	IRS, Trump Accounts	irs.gov/trumpaccounts
Form 4547; no published deadline; cannot be attached to Form 1040-X; non-filers may submit separately	IRS, Instructions for Form 4547	irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/i4547.pdf
\$5,000 annual limit, indexed after 2027; lock-up until 1 Jan of the year the child turns 18; traditional-IRA tax treatment; 10% early-distribution charge	IRS Notice 2025-68	irs.gov/pub/irs-drop/n-25-68.pdf
Employer contributions up to \$2,500 per employee per year, counted inside the \$5,000 limit	U.S. Department of Labor, Technical Release 2026-02	dol.gov/agencies/ebsa/employers-and-advisers/guidance/technical-releases/26-02
Gift tax safe harbor; present-interest treatment; annual exclusion \$19,000 for 2026	IRS Rev. Proc. 2026-25, issued 2026-06-29	irs.gov/pub/irs-drop/rp-26-25.pdf
PROPOSED investment rules: U.S. stock index funds only; total annual fees and expenses $\leq 0.10\%$; no sector-specific or ESG index; no borrowings or derivatives that materially increase risk of loss; 90% U.S.-company safe harbor. Comments close 2026-10-20	IRS and Treasury, proposed rule, Federal Register 2026-08-21, RIN 1545-BS14	federalregister.gov — “Guidance on Eligible Investments for Trump Accounts”
Reported delays; rejections corrected by phone	ABC7 / Associated Press, 2026-07-23	abc7ny.com — “Millions have signed up for Trump Accounts; families are waiting”
Foreign donors: gift tax treatment of cash transfers not fully settled, highly fact-specific	Forbes, Virginia La Torre Jeker, 2026-07-22	forbes.com/sites/virginialatorrejeker

What is settled, what is proposed, what is unanswered

Settled as of this printing: the \$1,000 pilot contribution and who it attaches to; the \$5,000 annual limit; the \$2,500 employer figure and that it sits inside the limit; the lock-up date; tax-deferred rather than tax-free treatment; Form 4547 and the absence of a published deadline; the gift tax safe harbor and its conditions.

Proposed, not final: four additions to the investment rules published 21 August 2026, comments open until 20 October 2026 — the ESG-index exclusion, the 90% U.S.-company safe harbor, the Investment Company Act registration requirement, and the definition of leverage. The fee cap, the index requirement and the sector exclusion are statute, not proposal.

Unanswered: whether 2026 is prorated; how these accounts are treated for college financial aid; several details that regulations have not yet reached.

Check it yourself in ten minutes

1. Open irs.gov/trumpaccounts by typing it, not by following a link you were sent.
2. Compare the figures there against Worksheet 3 — the \$5,000 and the \$2,500.
3. Search the Federal Register for “Trump Accounts” and look at the dates. Anything newer than 24 August 2026 is newer than this workbook.
4. Write what you found: _____

When this workbook is wrong

It will be, eventually. That is the nature of a topic where rules are still arriving.

- Date checked: _____ · Anything that had changed: _____
- Date checked: _____ · Anything that had changed: _____
- Date checked: _____ · Anything that had changed: _____

Corrections and questions: **dalia@thesovereign.academy**

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